MENDEL GRABSKI

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CLOUD SECURITY & SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT | MULTI-CLOUD |ZERO TRUST • IAM • MDM • IaC • K8s

Cloud Security Architect specializing in Secure-By-Design platforms at startup speed. Proven in delivering identity and device-centric Zero Trust architectures across Azure, AWS, and GCP, combining MDM/MAM (Intune, JAMF), endpoint posture (Kolide), and ZTNA (Cloudflare) to enforce continuous access verification across Windows, macOS, Linux, iOS, and Android. Expert in IaC and GitOps-driven platforms with policy guardrails that enable rapid delivery while reducing friction. Track record includes SOC 2 and GDPR compliance, global Zero Trust rollout, zero major security incidents, and 50% cloud cost reduction on a $4M/year baseline.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Azure Cloud Security Consultant – Highspring | Remote **9/2025 - present**

- Inherited 10 Azure tenants from acquisitions within highly regulated financial institutions and drove a 75%+ vulnerability reduction (20K <5K under 90 days) by operationalizing Wiz analysis, exposure management, and identity risk prioritization.
- Executed rapid, low-disruption remediation across Defender for Cloud, Entra (PIM, Conditional Access), Azure Firewall/NSGs, Azure Policy, driving containerization and migration from unmanaged VMs to Azure-managed service.
- Partnered with IAM, platform, and application teams to translate Wiz findings into scalable secure-by-design patterns and executive-ready risk reporting, accelerating approvals and remediation velocity under strict financial controls.

Founding Security Engineer | Head of Security & DevOps - MakeInfinite Labs | Remote **10/2022 - 10/2025**

- **Security Governance**: Built the company's security program from scratch automating multi-cloud landing zones integrated with Cloudflare ZTNA, enforcing identity and device-aware access for company managed devices and BYOD. Delivered Zero Trust and device trust by standardizing device posture and compliance using Intune, JAMF and Kolide enabling continuous verification, and conditional access enforcement. Deployed a consolidated cloud security stack (Wiz, Trivy, Snyk, Checkov), achieved SOC 2 with zero critical findings, and partnered with CISA as a Secure-by-Design pledge member.
- **Multi-Cloud Architecture**: Architected and operated secure, resilient Azure-first multi-cloud platforms across AWS, GCP, and Tencent, delivering unified networking (S2S/VPN, ingress, API gateways) and routing via Azure Virtual WAN, AWS Transit Gateway, and GCP VPN. Built a Terraform-driven GitOps control plane (Terragrunt, Atlantis, ArgoCD, Flux, Crossplane) standardizing AKS/EKS/GKE with zero-trust identity, policy enforcement, and active/active + DR-ready cluster federation.
- **CI/CD & Delivery Lifecycle**: Engineered and operated CI/CD pipelines across clouds using ArgoCD and Fleet for building and releasing Docker, Helm and Maven artifacts with Actions, ADO, JFrog Artifactory to public and private registries. Designed cross-cloud delivery workflows enabling consistent build, test, and deploy patterns regardless of target cloud platform.
- **ETL/ELT Pipelines:** Significantly improved data performance by implementing **active-active designs** cross-cloud leveraging Cloudflare and K8s. Leveraged Spark, Azure Data Factory and Azure Synapse, to achieve **sub-second query latency on 1M+ rows**, reduce IOPS load, and strengthen IAM using Service Connectors with OIDC/Workload Identity–based authentication.
- **Application Security:** Educated and empowered developers to make conscious secret-management decisions in code, driving passwordless solutions across apps, clusters, and pipelines. Integrated with Azure Key Vault, HashiCorp Vault, and 1Password operators; standardized enterprise-wide to enable zero-touch, customer- and audit-ready environments at scale.
- **AI & Developer Enablement**: Built internal AI solutions including a CLI + code-review assistant leveraging OpenAI, Claude, Gemini, and Azure AI Foundry. Implemented privacy guardrails and reduced engineering toil, decreasing PR cycle time by 40%.
- **Cloud Cost Optimization**: Drove a **50% reduction in multi-cloud spend** on a $4M/yr baseline (~$300k/mo.) through re-architecture, right-sizing workloads, tagging governance, autoscaling optimizations, and IaC-driven resource hygiene.

Cloud Engineer – Conduent | Remote **5/2022 - 12/2022**

- **Hybrid Connectivity**: Designed and implemented hybrid network using ExpressRoute, IPsec S2S VPNs, peering, custom UDRs, in a Hub and Spoke model, with routing and tunnel configuration in AWS to support cross-cloud failover where needed.
- **Security & Firewall**: Deployed and managed Azure Firewall, DDoS Protection, NSGs/ASGs, and third-party NVAs (Cisco, Palo Alto). Configured Private Link, Bastion, and AWS security equivalents to maintain secure access across hybrid workloads.
- **Compute & Scaling**: Provisioned and scaled Azure VMs (Availability Sets/Zones), Scale Sets, node pools, and App Service

Environments. Implemented HA patterns that extended into AWS EC2/EKS where hybrid architectures required it.

- **Application Delivery**: Configured FrontDoor, Load Balancers, App Gateways and built hybrid routing patterns to securely expose on-prem and cloud applications. Supported both Azure and AWS CloudFront configurations for unified delivery.
- **Client Delivery**: Advised customers on cloud architecture strategies, recommending solutions that optimize cost, and security. Led workload migrations into Azure and AWS, ensuring zero-downtime cutovers and secure application delivery.

Identity & Systems Engineer – Agiliant | Remote **3/2020 - 6/2022**

- **Azure Identity Management**: Designed and implemented a comprehensive zero-trust access framework using Azure AD and Okta (SAML/OAuth) for SSO, MFA and PIM; integrated Cloudflare Zero Trust - deploying Access, Tunnels, and Access Policies to secure both internal applications and external services across all device types.
- **Network Security**: Served as the lead security administrator across all client environments. Skilled in configuring and deploying Azure, Cisco, Palo Alto, Sophos, and pfSense firewalls, setting up VLANs, V-NETs, peering, UDRs, P2S, and S2S VPNs. Well-versed in operating and maintaining industry-leading network vendor NVAs, conducting security audits, identifying vulnerabilities, and implementing remediation plans.
- **Solutions Delivery**: Advised the customer on migrating on-premises file servers to SharePoint and transitioning identity from on-prem Active Directory to Entra ID and Okta. Designed a solution leveraging PIM, Intune, JAMF and Conditional Access to enable Zero Trust, maintain compliance, and enhance user experience, while partnering closely with IT and security teams to ensure seamless adoption and minimal downtime.
- **System Management**: Installed, configured, and maintained operating systems, application software, and system management tools. Ensured the highest levels of systems and infrastructure availability.
- **Automation & Scripting**: Developed backend scripts for redundant tasks and software download/install requests. Trained team members on leveraging automation to increase efficiency. Automated user onboarding processes for six clients using PowerShell.
- **Escalation Management**: Managed escalations from 1st, 2nd, and 3rd level support. Coordinated with vendors and other IT personnel for swift resolution and achieved a resolution Service Level Agreement (SLA) of 95% over a six-month period.

Manager – Walgreens | Various locations **01/2016 – 03/2020**

- **Store Conversion Project Leadership**: Led the conversion of 15 Rite-Aid stores to Walgreens. Managed deadlines, budgets, and change management, ensuring successful installation of new IT equipment and fixtures.
- **Marketing Strategy Development**: Developed and implemented marketing strategies that achieved the "go empty" stockroom goal within six months. Increased customer satisfaction from 58.6% to 74.4% in the fiscal year 2018.
- **Staff Performance Management**: Oversaw staff performance, provided feedback, conducted performance appraisals, and developed career paths. Enhanced team productivity and customer service standards.
- **Vendor Coordination & Process Optimization**: Coordinated with third-party vendors to streamline processes, converting stores in under five workdays. Identified and leveraged opportunities for operational improvements.
- **Training & Technical Support**: Provided specialized training and ongoing technical support for new IT systems and software. Troubleshot and maintained all computer hardware and software.

EDUCATION

- **Certifications:** SC-900 • AZ-900 • AZ-104 • AZ-500 • AZ-700 • **AZ-305** • AWS Cloud Practitioner • AWS SA Associate • **AWS SA Professional** • Terraform Associate
- **University of Phoenix |** Bachelor of Science: Criminal Justice, Minor in Cyber Crime

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure as Code & Platform: Terraform, OpenTofu, Terragrunt, Atlantis, Terrateam, Spacelift

Kubernetes & App Delivery: AKS, Rancher, Helm, Kro, Argo CD, Flux, Docker, Maven, Karpenter, Crossplane

IAM & Security: Entra ID, Okta, PIM, Azure Policy, OPA, Cloudflare (tunnels, ZTNA), Vault, ESO, 1Password, MDM

DevOps & CI/CD: GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, CircleCI, JFrog Artifactory, ArgoCD, Chainguard

Data & AI: Spark, Kyuubi, Synapse, Data Factory, Data Lake, Fabric, AI agents (OpenAI, Claude, Gemini)

Networking & Edge: Istio, Cloudflare R2, Workers, Tunnels; App Gateway, WAF/DDoS, ExpressRoute, VPN